

MUSIC FESTIVAL

Return of the Maestro

It's a fortnight packed with music by sitar maestro Pandit Ravi Shankar along with family and friends. At 88, Pandit Shankar is still beaming with energy as he performs at his concerts. When he was young he had a dream to create a hub where musicians and dancers could interact and discuss ideas. He fulfilled his dream with the setting up of the Ravi Shankar Institute of Music and Performing Arts (RIMPA) in Delhi. This year, RIMPA is organising a festival of classical music and dance from February 21 to 24. Slated for the first day are Krishna Mohan Bhatt (sitar) and Aruna Mohanty (Odissi). The next day, Jayateerth Mevundi, from the Kirana gharana, will present a vocal recital followed by a sitar recital by Kartik Seshadri. The Lalgudi style of playing the violin will come alive with a recital by Lalgudi G., J.R. Krishnan and Lalgudi Vijayalakshmi followed by a Bharatanatyam recital by Divya Devaguptapu. A vocal recital by young Manjiri Asanare-Kelkar followed by a Kathak performance by Uma Sharma will mark the finale. Pandit Shankar now plays a special

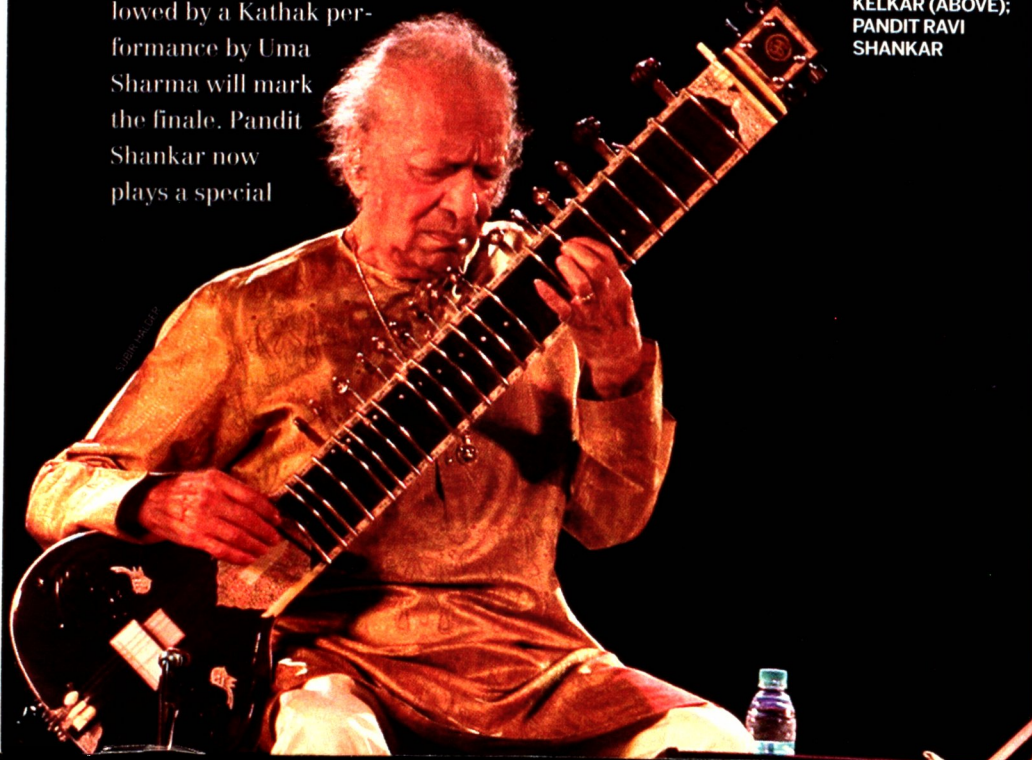
sitar designed to produce excellent tonal quality. The *Music in the Park* concert will be performed by the maestro and his daughter Anoushka Shankar at Nehru Park. For those who like fusion, The Anoushka Shankar Project, will be staged on March 8. The project, created in 2006, allows Anoushka to present her experimental creations. Along with her musicians, she explores the commonalities between the north and south Indian music traditions and makes connections with the West. At Select City Walk, Delhi.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit



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MANJIRI ASANARE-KELKAR (ABOVE);
PANDIT RAVI SHANKAR



A WORK BY SWAMI

ART EXHIBITION

Colour of LOVE

For centuries, *Kamasutra* has been an inspiration for artists. Taking a cue from this ancient text, artist Om Swami presents his latest show, *Love Sutra*. Using symbols of togetherness, Swami gives a new meaning to the pursuit of eternal love. To depict intimacy the works have sculptures of man and woman and sometimes of birds absorbed in togetherness in the background along with a careful play of symbols like hearts and Cupid's arrows. Swami does not show eroticism in his paintings; he subtly depicts the togetherness of couples by capturing moments of inner consciousness. "A man and woman are incomplete in themselves. They become close and together only in close togetherness. When this happens unconditionally they are complete," says Swami. A self-taught artist, he infuses imagination with technique by creating captivating canvases. The exhibition covers Swami's career spanning 15 years displaying a series of his paintings *Ganesha*, *Rebirth of Buddha*, *Love Unlimited* and *Moods*. From February 28 to March 6, at the Jehangir Art Gallery, Mumbai.

by Nikita Jain